



**Ghana's**  
Wraparound Fashion  
Classic Heritage

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## **Dedication**

I dedicate this handbook to my parents and teachers for their endless support, guide and encouragement throughout my academic journey.



## **Acknowledgement**

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to everyone who supported me in the successful completion of this handbook. My appreciation also goes to my family and friends for their constant support and, motivation.



# Introduction

Fashion in Ghana did not begin with modern clothes, it started with traditional style, created by our ancestor. Indigenous fashion in Ghana reflects the life style, believes and creativity of the people, from simple body coverings to beautiful designed fabrics like kente, each piece tells a story in this handbook, we take a journey through the world of Ghanaians indigenous fashion classics.

We explore how these styles were created, how they represent, and how they continue to inspire modern fashion trends.



# Declaration

I Akonnor Vida, commit to upholding the following ethical principles while creating my Ghanaian FashionClassics magazine:

## Consent & Permissions

I will obtain written permission from photographers, models, or copyright owners before using any image. For minors (under 18), I will get parental/guardian consent. I will always credit creators (e.g., photographers, designers) clearly. I will only use images from legal sources (no stolen social media or unlicensed stock photos).

## Respect & Cultural Sensitivity

I will ensure traditional clothing (like kaba and slit, ceremonial wear) is shown respectfully and with proper context. I will acknowledge the history and meaning of Ghanaian fashion classics (e.g., Adinkra symbols, queenmother's style). I will avoid stereotypes and showcase diverse Ghanaian styles, regions, and communities.

## Privacy & Honesty

I will not publish photos taken in private spaces without permission. I will not alter images to misrepresent cultural designs or intentions. Voluntary Participation I understand I do not have to include my own photos if I'm uncomfortable.

## Model Rights

I will treat models with dignity and clearly explain how their photos will be used. If applicable, I will agree to fair terms for their participation. Originality. I will credit all sources of inspiration (e.g., traditional designs, artists). I will prioritize using my own photos or properly licensed content.

## Accountability

I am responsible for ensuring my content follows Ghanaian laws (copyright, cultural heritage). I understand violations (e.g., unauthorized images, plagiarism) may lead to disciplinary action or legal consequences. By signing, I confirm I have read, understood, and agree to follow these guidelines.

Signature: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: Wed. 25th March, 2026

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# Breast and Waist covers

01



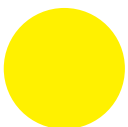


## Breast And Waist Covers

**B**reast and waist covers are among the earliest of clothing of the Ghanaian indigenous fashion. It is a two pieces of fabrics or clothes in which a single piece is wrapped around the chest, and the other piece is used to tie or wrapped around the waist on a female or a male to cover their private part. And this type of cloth is mostly worn by the young girls. These type of cloth or material used for that cloth is bark cloth figure 001.

### **Influence:**

**T**he style which was designed from breast and waist covers is now called top and fitting skirt and it is always worn by girls, as seen in Vida's figure002, fig. 003, fig. 004, fig. 005





*Fig. 001* Displays Vida in a Breast and Waist Cover Style. **Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA**



*Fig. 002 Displays Vida in a Breast and Waist Cover Style. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA*



*Fig. 003 Displays Vida in a Breast and Waist Cover Style. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA*





*Fig. 004 Displays Vida in a Breast and  
Waist Cover Style. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA*



*Fig. 005 Displays Vida in a Breast and  
Waist Cover Style. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA*

# Queen Mother's Style

# 2022

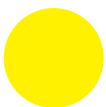


## Queen Mother' Style

Queen mother' style is also one of the Ghanaian indigenous classic fashion. Queen mother's style in traditional African societies, particularly in Ghana like the Ashanti or Krobo had distinctive styles in the olden days that symbolized authority, fertility and community leadership. The Queen mothers' style was worn by wrapping the cloth around the body leaving the shoulders and after wrapping it around, the rest of the cloth would be placed on the left arm in order not to fall off or loose, and this style is mostly worn to a ceremonial event as seen in figure 1.1.

### Influence:

The influence of the Queen mother's style is now turned into the off shoulder dresses. And this style is mostly worn for some special events. And this off shoulder style is worn by females. In figure... There is a wearer in off shoulder dress style. as seen in Vida's figure 1.2, fig. 1.3, fig. 1.4, fig. 1.5







*Fig. 1.1 Displays Vida in a Queen's Mother Style.*  
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*Fig.12 Displays Vida in a Queen's Mother Style.*  
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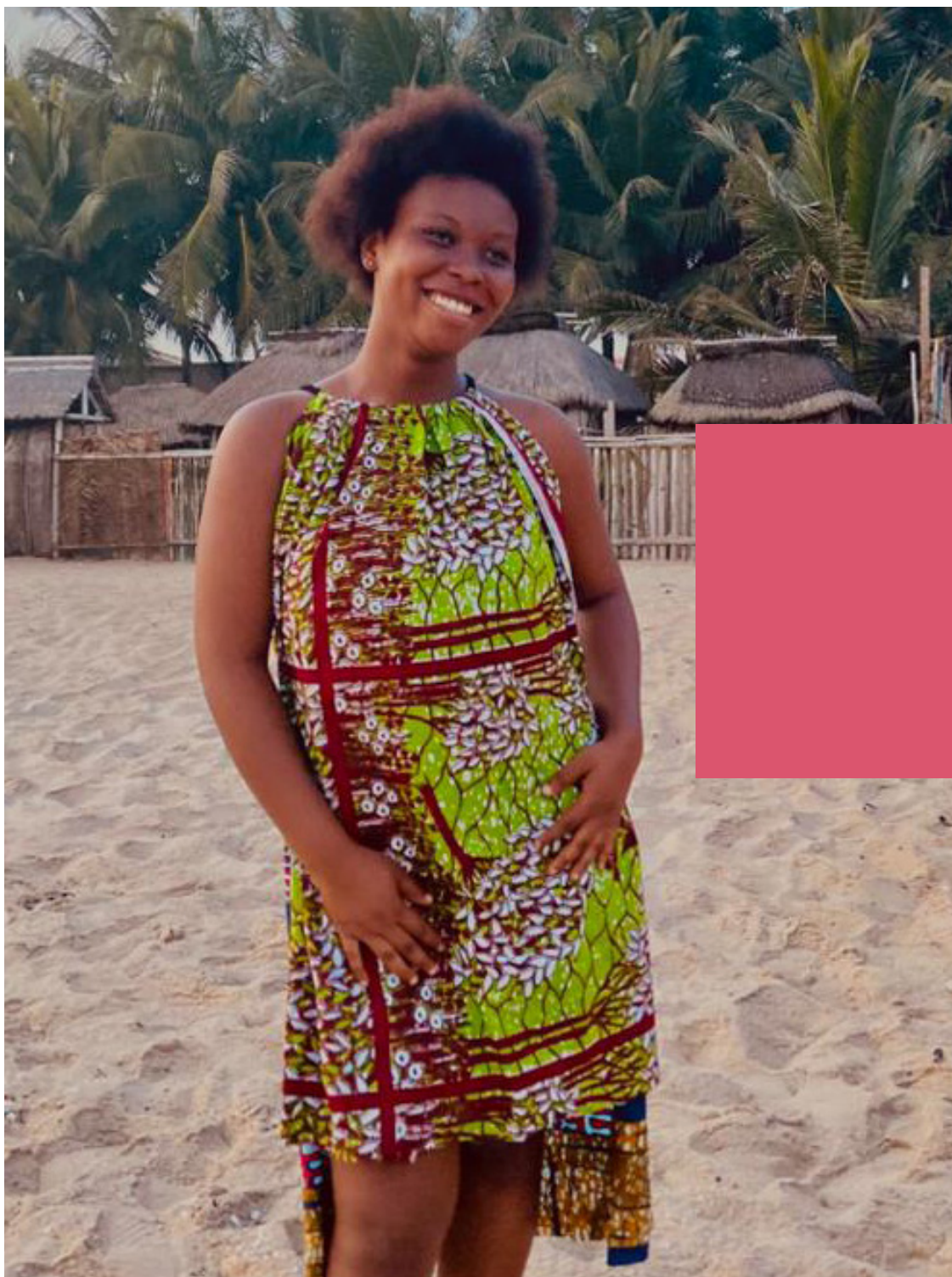


*Fig. 1.3 Displays Vida in a Queen's Mother Style.*  
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*Fig.1.4 Displays Vida in a Queen's Mother Style.*  
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*Fig. 1.5 Displays Vida in a Queen's Mother Style.*  
*Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA*



**Loin cloth —**

**03**





## Loin cloth

**L**oin cloth is one of the prehistorical forms of clothing, and it is made from a piece of cloth which is typically worn around the hips and groin area, often serving as a sole article of clothing in warm climates. It consist of a single rectangular piece of cloth, either wrapped around the body or secured with a belt. The material used for loin cloth includes bark cloth. In west and central Africa, the pagane is a wrapped fabric about 59 by 98 inches, function like a skirt when rolled at the waist. In figure... there is a wearer indigenous loin cloth style as seen in figure 2.1.

### **Influence:**

**T**he influence of loin cloth is now referred to swimming costumes or bikini. A bikini is a type of two pieces of swimsuits worn mainly by females, designed for swimming, sunbathing or beach wear, and it consist of pants and bra. There is a wearer in bikini in figure as seen in Vida's figure 2.2, fig. 2.3, fig. 2.4, fig. 2.5.





*Fig. 2.1 Displays Vida in a Loin Cloth.*  
**Source-ICEB MULTI-MEDIA**



*Fig. 2.2 Displays Vida in a Swimsuit.*  
**Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA**





Fig. 2.3 Displays Vida in a Beach Wear.  
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*Fig. 2.4 Displays Vida in a Beach Wear.*  
**Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA**



*Fig. 2.5 Displays Vida in a Beach Wear.*  
**Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA**



A background image of a woman with dark, curly hair, looking slightly to the side. The image is overlaid with a semi-transparent blue filter. In the top left corner, there is a yellow rectangular box containing the text 'Collar style'. At the bottom, the number '04' is displayed in a large, light blue font.

## Collar style

04

## Collar style

**C**ollar style is also one of the Ghanaian indigenous fashion classics. Collar is a piece of fabric which is wrapped around the neck and chest and tied it up at the back of the neck, this type of style is worn by both genders in Ghana, collar style can be worn to funeral and ceremonial events in the precolonial time. There is a wearer in indigenous collar style in figure as seen in figure 3.1.

### **Influence:**

**T**he collar style in this modern world is now called halter, slip and hold my neck. It is wrapped around the neck, which is typically sleeveless designs. And this exposes the arms shoulders, and this style of dress can be worn parties. There is a wearer in modern collar style in figure as seen in Vida's figure 3.2, fig. 3.3, fig. 3.4, fig. 3.5.



*Fig. 3.1* Displays Vida in a Collar Style.  
Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA





*Fig. 3.2 Displays Vida in a Contemporary Collar Style. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA*



*Fig. 3.3 Displays Vida in a Contemporary Collar Style. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA*



**Fig. 3.5** Displays Vida in a Contemporary Collar Style. **Source—iCEB MULTI-MEDIA**



## **Raffia skirt**

05



## Raffia skirt

Raffia skirt is also one of the Ghanaian indigenous fashion classics. A raffia skirt is a traditional garment made from fibers of the raffia palm. It is commonly worn on the body parts starting from the waist to the knee level, raffia skirt was mainly worn by the priest. And the raffia skirt was worn during ceremonial events, there is a wearer in indigenous raffia skirt as seen in figure 4.1.

### **Influence:**

The style which was generated or created from raffia skirt in this modern world is called pleated skirt, gathering skirt and flare skirt. This skirt is also worn around the waist and it has a band or elastic in the waist of the skirt and it can be worn anytime. There is a wearer in gathering skirt in figure 4.2, fig. 4.3, fig. 4.4, fig. 4.5.



*Fig. 4.1 Displays Marie in Raffia Skirt.*  
**Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA**



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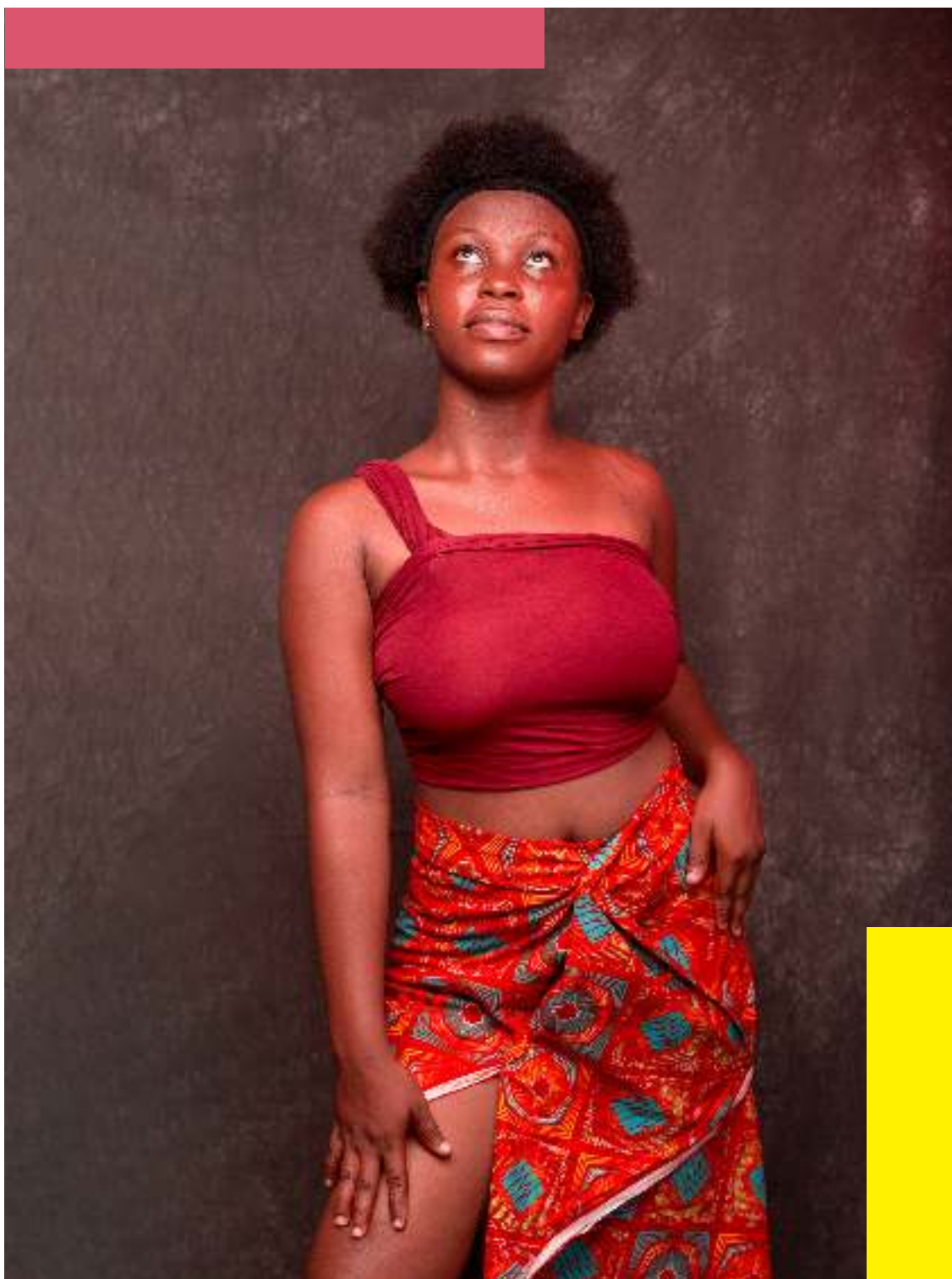




*Fig. 4.3* Displays Vida in Contemporary Raffia Skirt. *Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA...*



*Fig. 4.4 Displays Vida in Bubble Skirt. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA...*



*Fig. 4.5 Displays Vida in Flare Skirt. Source-iCEB MULTI-MEDIA...*



A woman with curly hair is shown from the chest up, looking over her shoulder towards the camera. The image is heavily overlaid with a semi-transparent blue filter. In the upper left corner, there is a solid yellow horizontal bar. The bottom left corner features a diagonal split between blue and red. The word "CONCLUSION" is printed in large, white, serif capital letters in the lower right area.

**CONC  
LUSION**

## Conclusion

Ghanaian indigenous fashion reflects the rich cultural heritage, values and identity of its people. From traditional wrap around style to breast and waist, each clothing piece carries deep historical and symbolic meaning. These garments were not only used for protection but also served as expressions of status, beauty and tradition. In conclusion, Ghanaian indigenous fashion is more than clothing. It is a powerful representation of history, creativity and cultural identity that continues to inspire the world today.



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